

WfP 2025 mini-paper rubric

The mini-paper is worth 20% of the final course grade.

The mini-paper will be marked only for the features listed in the table below (i.e. the features of introduction writing we have discussed in class in weeks 1-3 and the additional features discussed in the supplementary advice document on Blackboard).

It will **not** be marked for other aspects such as grammar, style, etc.

This is to encourage you not to use AI and other writing aids too much. The work will not be assessed for the thing AI is best at: grammar. You can make lots of grammar mistakes, and as long as I can understand your meaning, they will not affect your grade.

The marking categories are as follows.

	Category	Mark	Reference to the course
1	Overall, the shape of the introduction corresponds to the first part of the hourglass; the introduction contains the O and the C of OCAR and has a logical order of information.	5	Weeks 1 and 2
2	Succeeds in the first function of the opening: providing ideas that the reader can relate to in order to give a context to the paper.	5	Week 2
3	If you are writing about a real, complex topic, the start of the introduction is the right width: the level of the first sentences of the introduction match the level of the reader (i.e. me, Dr Rowland, the person marking it). If you are writing a fictional mini-paper about a simple topic, this category does not matter; you will probably have no choice but to write a very basic start to your opening, and that is fine. I will not penalise you for it.	5	Supplementary advice document principle 1
4	The first words of the opening are not wasted and the general topic of the paper is reached as soon as reasonably possible. The opening is concrete as soon as reasonably possible.	5	Supplementary advice document principles 2 and 3
5	Succeeds in the second function of the opening: lets the reader understand the challenge and convinces them that addressing the challenge is achievable and necessary.	5	Week 2
6	Clear challenge.	5	Weeks 1 and 2 and supplementary advice document principles 4 and 5
7	Suitable use of tense.	5	Week 3 and last slide of the supplementary

			advice document
8	Word count of 350-1000 words.	5	See below
9	Follows rules on use of sophisticated electronic writing aids such as AI, machine translation, Grammarly etc.	10	See AI usage document
Total		50	

Marking category 8 – word count

Don't feel that you have to write a long introduction. A word count of at least 400 words will be useful when you use your writing for editing practice in the second half of the course, but there's no need to aim for the top end of the word limit. The upper limit is 1000 words just in case a few students writing about real topics need this larger word count. 1000 words is not a target and I hope most of you will not write this much!

To get full marks in this category, your word count must be between 350 and 1000. For every 20 words over 1000 or under 350, 0.5 marks will be deducted. So, for example, a word count of 1020 would score 4.5, and a word count of 300 would score 4.

The mini-paper must be your work

As the task instructions in week 2's PPT said, the mini-paper must be your work. You cannot submit something that you have written in collaboration with other people (e.g. an introduction from an article you have already published). If you submit an introduction that was co-authored with other people, or has been edited by other people, you will receive a grade of 0 and you will not be able to make another submission.